

Jean d Amour Akimanizanye

Senior Backend / Full-Stack Engineer

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Professional Summary

Backend-focused Full-Stack Engineer with about 10 years of experience designing, building, and scaling **API-driven systems, SaaS platforms, and cloud-native applications**. Strong expertise in **Python, TypeScript, Node.js, React, AWS, PostgreSQL, Docker, and Nginx**, with experience in **distributed and multi-tenant architectures, API design, cloud deployment, and performance optimization**. Proven track record of building reliable production **systems supporting 10,000+ users**, including a **multi-tenant internet radio platform built with Go, Python/Django, React, and Nginx supporting at least 1,000 concurrent listeners**.

Known for writing **clean, maintainable backend systems** and **delivering reliable solutions** from architecture through production.

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Go, PHP

Backend & APIs: Node.js, Express.js, FastAPI, Django, REST APIs, GraphQL

Frontend: React, Redux

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda), Docker, CI/CD, Nginx, Linux

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Couchbase, Redis, DynamoDB

Architecture: Multi-tenant systems, distributed systems, event-driven systems, API design, system design

Streaming & Real-Time: HTTP audio streaming, concurrent connections, real-time data handling

Integrations: Stripe, PayPal, Braintree, Google Pay

Practices: TDD, code reviews, Agile, performance optimization, production troubleshooting

Professional Experience

Lead Software Engineer / Huza HR / Oct 2021 – Present / Kigali, Rwanda

Backend & system architecture lead for enterprise HR SaaS platform

- Designed and implemented **scalable backend architecture and REST APIs** powering payroll, employee management, and reporting systems
- Built **event-driven workflows** automating employee lifecycle processes, reducing manual operations

- Deployed and managed **Dockerized services on AWS** with CI/CD pipelines, improving release reliability
- Improved **system latency by 10%** through backend refactoring and database optimization
- Led **technical decision-making, system design, and incident resolution** in production environments
- Enabled scalable multi-tenant architecture supporting enterprise clients

Software Engineer / GitStart / Nov 2021 – Dec 2024 / Remote (USA). Part-time

Contributed to high-scale production systems across globally used platforms.

- Implemented **backend scalability improvements** for Sourcegraph's enterprise search infrastructure
- Optimized **Supabase real-time systems**, improving performance for thousands of concurrent connections
- Built **production-ready backend features and CMS extensions** for Strapi in large-scale deployments

Software Engineer / Benipal Technologies / Dec 2020 – Aug 2021 / Remote (USA)

- Refactored **legacy backend systems**, improving maintainability and performance
- Integrated **multi-provider payment systems** (Stripe, PayPal, Braintree, Google Pay)
- Built **notification systems using Firebase Cloud Messaging**
- Supported backend R&D for scalable system improvements

Team Lead & Software Engineer / Andela / Apr 2019 – Jun 2020 / Kigali, Rwanda

- Led a team of 5 engineers delivering **full-stack applications with strong backend foundations**
- Built a **pharmaceutical inventory system** with real-time stock tracking
- Developed backend services using **PHP (Lumen) and Couchbase**
- Mentored engineers and conducted code reviews

Software Developer / Data Systems Ltd / Aug 2016 – Mar 2019 / Kigali, Rwanda

- Built **LMS platform (MEAN stack)** supporting **10,000+ users**
- Developed an **offline-capable desktop application**, published on the Microsoft Store

Notable Projects

Multi-Tenant Internet Radio Streaming Platform | Go, Python, Django, React, Nginx, Linux

- Built and hosted a multi-tenant internet radio platform.

- Used Go for **audio streaming**, Python/Django for **APIs and station management**, and React for the **UI/Dashboard**.
- Designed the streaming service to support at least **1,000 concurrent listeners**

AJA Store – Transaction Platform | Python, GraphQL, React, Nginx

- Developed backend services for **real-time transaction processing**
- Built analytics dashboards with **live data updates**

Education

Bachelor of Computer Science | University of Rwanda | 2012 – 2016

Languages

Kinyarwanda – Native | **English** – Fluent (C2)

Interests & Activities

Hiking (Bisoke & Muhavura summits), **reading** personal development books (*'The Happiness Advantage'*), and **volunteering** in community tech initiatives.